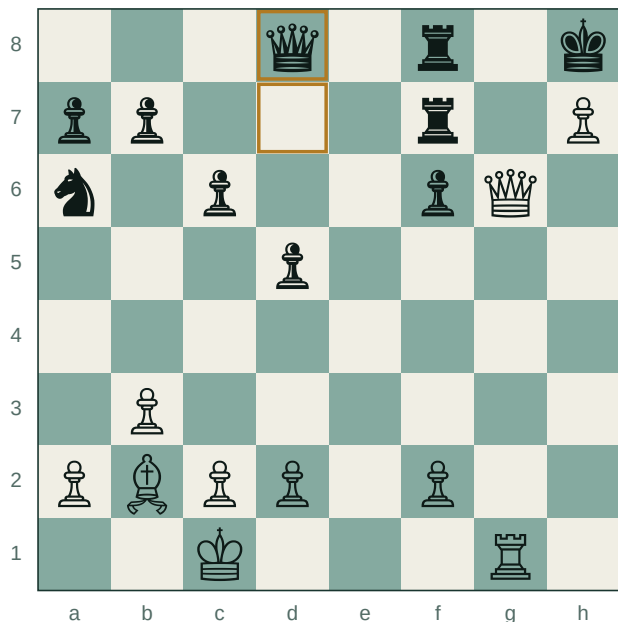


Promotion combinations: White, move 25

Promotion combinations

White to move



Previous move: 24...Qd8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

25. Bxf6+ Qxf6 26. Qg8+ Rxcg8 27. hxcg8=Q#

25.Bxf6+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. From f6 it attacks king on h8 and queen on d8. Recorded reply: **25...Qxf6**.

26.Qg8+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From g8 it attacks king on h8, rook on f8 and rook on f7. Recorded reply: **26...Rxcg8**.

27.hxcg8=Q# Mate: queen on g8 gives check; Black has no legal reply. The pawn becomes a queen.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on g8. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Always inspect stalemate and underpromotion resources. A queen is usually strongest, but the exact position determines the choice.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An advanced pawn can turn a tactical sequence into a new queen or another useful piece. Promotion may occur with capture or check, and the choice of piece can change the outcome.

HOW TO LOOK

Calculate the pawn's route, the safety of the promotion square, and whether the new piece can survive or give a decisive check.

The defending king is on h8. Absolute pin: pawn on f6.